Bay of Bengal region, and also to increase visibility of BIMSTEC.

The Twentieth Meeting of BIMSTEC Trade Negotiating Committee was held during 7-9 September 2015, Pullman Khon Kaen Raja Orchid, Thailand.

The Third Meeting of the BIMSTEC Expert Group on the Establishment of the Technology Transfer Facility was held from 25-26 August 2015 at Colombo, Sri Lanka.

The Seventh Meeting of the BIMSTEC Joint Working Group on Counter-Terrorism and Transnational Crime was held in Bangkok, Thailand from 04-05 August 2015. They discussed issues pertaining to Counter Terrorism and Transnational Crime in the Bay of Bengal Region. The Meeting also finalized the BIMSTEC Convention on Mutual Legal Assistance in Criminal Matters.

Till date four BIMSTEC Summits have been held. The first was in Bangkok, 2004, second in New Delhi, 2008, third in Nay Pyi Taw, Myanmar, 2014, the fourth in Kathmandu, Nepal, 2018 and the latest in Visakhapatnam, India, 2019.

The 4th BIMSTEC was held in Kathmandu, Nepal in August 2018. Prime Minister of Nepal, K. P. Sharma Oli handed over the Chairmanship to the then Sri Lankan President, Maithripala Sirisena. The BIMSTEC leaders pledged to strengthen the organization. The Kathmandu Declaration upholds collective wisdom and a future vision for a sustainable and peaceful BIMSTEC region through the BIMSTEC declaration, ***Towards a Peaceful, Prosperous and Sustainable Bay of Bengal Region***. Among other highlights, the leaders affirmed their faith in building future plans for cooperation among BIMSTEC countries with required institutional reforms of BIMSTEC, reaffirmed their faith in the Charter of the UN, pledged to fight terrorism and transnational crimes, alleviate poverty, improve transport and communication, boost trade and investment, expressed concern for environment and disaster management, climate change, energy, pledged to increase cooperation in field of energy, technology, agriculture, fisheries, public health, culture, tourism and increasing people-to-people contacts. The other focus areas were developing mountain economy and blue economy.

India hosted the 2019 BIMSTEC Summit at Visakhapatnam (7